

Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 2024

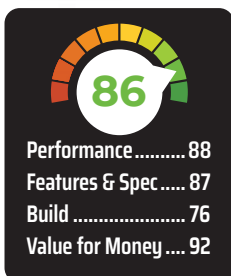
Best in class performance

₹1,79,999



acer is back with the Acer Predator Helios

Neo 16 2024, continuing last year's newly launched Helios Neo lineup. Last year we saw the release of several "budget premium" gaming laptops, which offered top-of-the-line hardware while being comparatively easy on the wallet, especially compared to other high-end gaming laptop offerings. One of our favourites from last year was the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16, part of Acer's premium Predator Helios lineup of gaming laptops. While the Predator Helios series usually falls under the premium gaming laptop category costing north of INR 2 lakhs, the Predator Helios Neo lineup was introduced to make the Predator more attainable for the masses. While we still wouldn't call it cheap, priced between INR 1 to 1.8 lakhs, the specs you get are comparable to gaming laptops at much higher prices. We were very impressed with the Helios Neo 16's performance last



year, and we were excited to see how well the new 2024 model performs. But before that, let's get the specs out of the way.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The new Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 2024 borrows a lot from Acer's premium Predator Helios lineup in terms of design language. There are also a few subtle changes from last year's Neo 16 variant. While you don't get the very best in terms of build quality that Acer has to offer, what you do get still feels very premium. The overall build comprises aluminium which is used in the lid, and polycarbonate for the rest of the body. The protruding rear of the laptop has a transparent coating on the top with the words Helios Neo 16 between an angular pattern; similar to previous gen Helios laptops. On the lid itself, you have a Predator logo in the centre with RGB lighting and alphanumeric text at the bottom right which is an encrypted message from Acer. We'll leave the decoding to you.

The Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 comes with a chiclet keyboard with satisfactory travel and feedback. It's also a full-sized keyboard featuring a numpad. The size and spacing of the keys were also good making for an overall pleasant typing and gaming experience. The keyboard features 4-zone RGB backlighting which can be customised via the PredatorSense software. The precision touchpad is slightly off-centre to avoid getting in the way while typing.

I/O PORTS

You have a great selection of ports with the Predator Helios Neo 16. Starting with the rear, you have the DC-in port, an HDMI 2.1 port, and 2 USB-C Thunderbolt 4 ports. Then on the left side, you have the Ethernet port, a USB-A 3.2 Gen 1 port, a microSD card reader, and a 3.5mm audio combo jack. Finally, you have 2 USB-A 3.2 Gen 2 ports on the right side of the laptop.

THERMALS

The Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 2024 comes with the 5th generation of Acer's AeroBlade 3D fan tech. The laptop also uses liquid metal over thermal paste for cooling. Cool air intake happens from the bottom, and vents are located on the rear and sides of the laptop.

As far as thermal performance is concerned, the new Helios Neo 16 is middle of the pack. It doesn't run too hot, but certain clusters, like the middle of the laptop, can go over the 40-degree Celsius mark. The rest of the laptop's surface averages temperatures of around 30 degrees Celsius. The CPU hit a peak temperature of 88 degrees Celsius during our CPU stress test which is within expectations. Meanwhile, the GPU hit peak temperatures of around 81 degrees Celsius during intensive gaming sessions which is again not too high or too low.

DISPLAY

We were very impressed with the display of last year's iteration of the Helios Neo 16. The trend continues this year as well. The Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 2024